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Policy/Guideline Title:	Recruitment and Selection Policy		
Executive Summary:	The purpose of this policy and associated guidance is to promote and encourage the achievement and maintenance of the highest possible standards in all aspects of the recruitment and selection of staff.		
Supersedes:	Version 4		
Description of Amendment(s):	Updated job titles and removal of Bank Partners and updated values Legal update - 5.8 – contract should be provided on first day of employment		
This policy will impact on:			
Financial Implications:			
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Issued By:	Kathryn Large, Senior HR Business Partner	Expiry Date:	April 2026
Author:	Rebecca Bell, Deputy Head of Resourcing	Impact Assessment Date:	
APPROVAL RECORD			
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Received for Information:			

A.1: Recruitment and Selection Policy



Compassion



Accountability



Respect



Integrity



Courage

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Appendix

1. Introduction

The purpose of this policy and associated guidance is to promote and encourage the achievement and maintenance of the highest possible standards in all aspects of the recruitment and selection of staff.

2. Purpose

This policy is intended to define the Trust's recruitment and selection standards and to state the roles and responsibilities required within the recruitment and selection process. The Trust believes that effective recruitment and selection is key to assess the calibre and suitability of candidates.

All recruitment and selection activity must adhere to relevant national equality, human rights and contractual legislation to ensure that no unlawful activity. NHS Employers Standards must be met in order to ensure that people are fit and proper to undertake the role recruited too.

The requirements of this policy apply to all recruitment and/or selection activity within the Trust, including non-medical recruitment, medical staffing recruitment, external and internal secondments, bank workers, agency workers and volunteers.

This policy aims to:

1. To ensure that applicants and candidates are treated with compassion, treating them as individuals that matter
2. We introduce ourselves at every stage of the recruitment and selection process to make individuals feel comfortable; emotionally and physically
3. To be respectful in the way we behave as part of the recruitment and selection process
4. To be accountable and take responsibility and ownership for recruitment and selection decisions and actions in line with the Trust vision, Dedicated to Excellence values and strategic objectives
5. To explain things clearly, in simple language, to build trust with applicants and candidates
6. We treat candidates and applicants the same whilst valuing the experience and contribution they bring to the recruitment and selection process
7. We facilitate an open environment for dialogue engaging with a purpose as an ambassador for the Trust
8. To ensure pre-employment checks are carried out to meet NHS Employment Check Standards

3. Responsibilities

Joint Consultative and Negotiation Committee (JCNC)

provides formal channels for consultation and negotiation of this policy.

Director of People has responsibility for ensuring implementation and monitoring of the HR Policies and Procedures and that systems are in place.

Executive Directors, General Managers, Business Unit Directors, Finance Business Partners and HR Managers will review all vacancies, ensuring appropriate approval is given enabling the recruitment to proceed.

Recruiting Managers will ensure that any vacancy has been appropriately approved prior to commencing recruitment. Their prime responsibility is to ensure the selection of candidates of the right calibre by ensuring that appropriate and effective selection methods are utilised whilst also adhering to all employment legislation, NHS Employers Standards and any appropriate Trust policy or procedure. They are also responsible for ensuring that all recruitment documentation is completed and the recruitment systems are updated accordingly.

Interview Panel Members will ensure that they adhere to the principles and practice of all employment legislation and complete and sign all relevant recruitment documentation in relation to the interview process.

Recruitment Services will be responsible for the introduction, application and monitoring of this policy, including providing formal and informal training where required. The teams are responsible for ensuring that day to day recruitment and selection processes are non-discriminatory, efficient, legally and nationally compliant and are responsible for the provision of advice, guidance and support in recruitment, selection and redeployment. They will provide a front-line recruitment service, including advising on the recruitment process, providing recruitment administration and coordinating pre-employment checks in line with the NHS Employers Pre-Employment check standards.

Occupational Health will ensure that all non-medical candidates, medical staffing candidates, internal applicants, secondees, temporary staff and volunteers have appropriate health clearance and provide advice to Recruiting Managers in respect of reasonable adjustments required for their employment.

4. Definitions

Trust - for this policy is Kettering General Hospital NHS Foundation Trust

Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) – is an Executive Agency of the Government (replacing the Criminal Records Bureau (CRB), which provides wider access to criminal record information through a checking service. This service enables organisations in the public, private and voluntary sectors to make safer recruitment decisions by identifying candidates who may be unsuitable for certain work, especially that involve children or vulnerable adults. The CRB was established under the Police Act 1997 and was launched in March 2002. The DBS replaced the CRB in 2012.

Permanent Staff – A person who is employed with the intention of there being an on-going employment relationship for an indefinite period which may be full or part time.

Bank Worker – A worker who has a contract, who books work dependant on their availability to work and the work available to them.

Agency Worker – An agency worker is someone who has a contract with an Employment Agency but works temporarily for and under the direction and supervision of a hirer.

This policy is consistent with relevant legislation including Equality Act 2010, The Rehabilitation of Offenders Act, Asylum and Immigration Act. This policy should be read in conjunction with;

- Disclosure of a Criminal Background and Rehabilitation of Offenders Policy
- Grievance (including Bullying and Harassment) Policy
- Safeguarding Vulnerable Adults Policy
- Policy for Safeguarding Children
- Professional Registration Policy
- Temporary Staffing Policy
- Corporate and Local Induction Policy
- Probationary Period Policy
- Fit & Proper Person Policy
- Secondment Policy

5. Recruitment Process

5.1 Recruiting Managers

It is the responsibility of Recruiting Managers to determine if there is a vacancy within their ward/department/service. Where the recruiting manager decides it is within the businesses best interest to recruit to the vacancy, they must obtain appropriate authorisation to recruit. A new post is deemed to be any post that is in addition to the current funded establishment or a post that is causing a substantive variation to the existing funded establishment (without directly affecting any other post in the establishment). No new post can be recruited to unless the source of funding has been clearly identified. All posts must be approved in accordance with the Trust vacancy control process. The trust vacancy control process does not include temporary agency or bank placements this is covered by the Temporary Staffing Policy.

5.2 Job Descriptions & Person Specifications

A Job description and Person Specification is required for a recruitment process to happen. For further information regarding the writing of job descriptions, person specifications and the job evaluation process please refer to the Recruitment and Selection guidance document.

5.3 Advertising

The job advertisement is the main source of attracting good candidates, as it is the first contact candidates have with the Trust. The contents of the advert should

accurately reflect the nature of the job in order that potential employees can obtain a fair picture of the vacant post. It is important to ensure that the wording of advertisements is not discriminatory and adheres to current employment legislation. For further information regarding the advertising process please refer to the Recruitment and Selection guidance document.

All adverts must have interview dates appearing. Recruiting managers can close vacancies early, where it is clearly stated in advert. You may be asked to review late applications, where adverts have closed early, for those people with disabilities as a reasonable adjustment.

Expression of interests can only be used where it offers a departmental acting up / learning / development opportunities. No expression of interest should be advertised trust wide via A-Z all staff email this should be done advertised on the trust microsite or NHS Jobs. Expression of interests cannot be used to make a substantive appointment.

No external recruitment should be advertised via A-Z all staff email, unless with the express permission of the Director of People.

5.4 Shortlisting

Recruiting managers should always be aware of employment legislation and be fair, consistent and only shortlist against the person specification. As a minimum you should:

- Shortlist all those who meet the essential criteria
- If there are significant numbers select against desirable criteria

All recruiting managers must shortlist applications where they meet the all the essential criteria and have indicated they qualify under the disability confident scheme.

For further information regarding the shortlisting process please refer to the Recruitment and Selection guidance document.

5.5 Interviews and Assessments

Interviews and assessments should be conducted to select a candidate or candidates for appointment following the shortlisting process. For further guidance regarding interviews and assessments please refer to the Recruitment and Selection guidance document.

5.6 Conditional Offers of Employment

Once a candidate or candidates have been selected a conditional offer of employment can be made. For further guidance regarding conditional offers of employment please refer to the Recruitment and Selection Guidance document.

5.7 Pre-Employment Checks

All candidates recruited into the Trust must undergo pre-employment checks. Preemployment checks are set in line with NHS Employers and Care Quality Commission standards and include (but are not limited to)

- Verification of Identification
- Right to Work
- Employment History
- Work Health Assessment
- Disclosure of Criminal Background (DBS) Check (where applicable)
- Professional Registration & Qualification Checks (where applicable)
- Health Professionals Alert Notice (HPAN) Check (where applicable)
- Fit and Proper Person Check (where applicable)

Consideration may be given to pre-employment checks standards where there are issues in obtaining them, where it directly or indirectly relates to an applicant/candidate's age i.e. coming straight out of school or college into work with no verification of identification. Any consideration applied must be clearly documented as part of the recruitment process.

Candidates who fail to provide satisfactory pre-employment checks, or who do not meet the necessary standards, may have an offer of employment withdrawn from them.

5.8 Unconditional Offers and Contract of Employment

An unconditional offer and contract of employment should only be made once the employment checks outlined above have been met. A contract of employment is the legal relationship that exists between the employer and the employee and should be issued on the first day of starting work.

5.9 Starting Work and Induction Arrangements

The Trust's induction policy must be followed by all new staff. The Trust policy requires managers to ensure their new employee attends the Corporate Induction on their first day at work (or this is risk assessed if not possible) and that a departmental induction takes place. Please refer to the Corporate and Local Induction Policy for full details, pro-forma and guidance.

5.10 Secondments

The Trust recognises that secondments offer valuable opportunities for staff development as well as providing a solution to short and medium term service needs. A secondment may be defined as *"The temporary loan of an employee to another organisation, or to a different part of the same organisation, for a specific purpose for a specific time to mutual benefit of all parties"*. This policy applies to staff that are seconded within the Trust, seconded to or from another NHS organisation, seconded to or from a non-NHS organisation. For further guidance please refer to the Secondment Policy and Recruitment and Selection Guidance document.

5.11 Agency and Bank Workers

Bank workers will be recruited and selected by Staff Bank. Agency workers will be sourced by Staff Bank. Staff Bank ensure Bank and Agency workers have undertaken pre-employment checks to NHS Employers standards commensurate with the work undertaken at the Trust, in line with the Temporary Staffing policy.

5.12 Applicant/Candidate Discrimination Complaints

It is the expectation that the recruiting manager resolves any issues/disputes arising from recruitment and selection. In the event that an applicant wishes to make a formal complaint about their recruitment, complaints must be made in writing to the Deputy Head of Resourcing in line with ACAS guidance on asking and responding to questions of discrimination in the workplace.

6. Training

The Trust will provided training and guidance for recruiting managers and also ensure that they are made aware of this policy.

7. Monitoring Compliance with the Document

Monitoring Compliance					
Process to be used for monitoring e.g. audit	Responsible individual / committee for carrying out monitoring	Frequency of monitoring	Responsible individual / committee for review the results	Responsible individual / committee for developing action plan	Responsible individual / committee for monitoring action plan
Equality breakdown of applicant, shortlisted candidate and new starter	Head of People Planning	Annual	JCNC	Head of People Planning	People Committee

Compliance audit	TIAA	Bi-Annual	Audit Committee	Head of People Planning	People Committee
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8. References

Employment Rights Act 1996
 Equality Act 2010
 Rehabilitation of Offenders Act 1974
 Asylum and Immigration Act 2004